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Listing May Reopen Jordan River Mine

A plan to take over Cerna Copper Ltd. in order to resume production at its Jordan River mine is being presented to Vancouver Stock Exchange Thursday.

President E. C. Dobell of Vancouver said approval will be sought for an exchange of shares with an unnamed company with which Cerna has been negotiating. Cerna is the new name for Cowichan Copper Co. Ltd., which operated the Sunro mine on lease from Cominco Ltd.

The Sunro mine, just upstream from Jordan River community, was closed last November for the third time since 1962 when pre-production operations began. Flooding closed the mine for two years and financial and management problems adversely affected operations in the period 1966-68.

Dobell, who replaced Oswood G. MacDonald as Cowichan president, said a decision on the mine's future would be known within two weeks.

PRODUCTION SUSPENDED

Production at the mine was suspended last September and for two months the mine crew carried on development work aimed at bringing new ore deposits into use.

As a "temporary measure," Dobell said, assets of Cerna were transferred to a private company with the intention of turning them over to a public company again. Current negotiations are aimed at bringing this about.

If the plan is accepted by Vancouver Stock Exchange, the mine would be reopened and for about three months development work would be done, Dobell said. Mining would resume about December.

It is proposed to continue with underground mining rather than open a new ore zone at surface for open pit operation.

Dobell said Cerna plans to convert from tracked diesel haulage to rubber-tired vehicles to improve efficiency.

The mine and mill for processing ore is rated at 1,500 tons per day but due to the nature of equipment only about 1,200 tons a day was possible, Dobell said. With improvements, this output could be raised to 2,000 tons per day, he suggested.

The first development would be a 600-foot drift into the Cave zone to expose new ore.

. . . McGEER

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people of this area to elect young, dynamic Liberal candidates."

McGeer said his greatest strength has been shown in the interior and named Kamloops, Caribou, Kootenay, Columbia River, Yale-Lillooet and Boundary-Similkameen as ripe for Liberal plucking.

"Social Credit has collapsed," he said.

WHAT EFFECT

He was asked what effect Premier Bennett's announcement Monday that Phil Gaglardi would again be given a cabinet portfolio would have in Kamloops.

"We are going to win there," he replied. "That promise typifies the old politics of the Socreds. People are rejecting this kind of electioneering all over the province."

The Liberal fire has spread to the coast and the north, McGeer said, with Liberal victories assured in Prince Rupert and Atling ridings.

McGeer made no predictions about the five seats in the Victoria area, except for Oak Bay which he counts as one of six the Liberals will retain from the last legislature.

NEEDS REVITALIZATION

McGeer said as premier he would fire no civil servants but will remove Pollution Control Board chairman F. S. McKinnon.

"We will not fire deputy ministers," he said. "But the civil service needs revitalization and we will be recruiting dynamic, young men.

"The civil service needs an examination from top to bottom."

After the cavalcade wound its way through the downtown area, the McGeer campaign bus moved to Oak Bay where the Liberal leader met Mayor Fred Hawes.

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